



# Talk to data

## Phase 7 – Controlled pilot and user testing - Annexes

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May 2026 - V1

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# 1. How to use this annex

These annexes provide optional working templates for Phase 7: Controlled pilot and user testing. They are intended as practical starter materials for planning, running, monitoring and assessing a controlled Talk-to-Data pilot.

They are not all mandatory outputs. Teams should select the artefacts that match the delivery intent, risk level, user population, data sensitivity and maturity of the MVP.

For a small POC or expert-user pilot, several templates may be simplified or combined. A one-page user guide, lightweight operating plan and simple feedback log may be enough.

For a broader business pilot, decision-critical use case or MVP on a production path, the evidence standard should be higher. User documentation, access lifecycle evidence, feedback-to-trace linkage, monitoring, issue triage, controlled change, support handover and pilot decision records should be treated more seriously.

The annexes should not turn Phase 7 into a heavy governance exercise. Their role is to make the pilot controlled, observable and decision-useful. Teams should use the templates that help them answer the core Phase 7 question: whether the MVP can be used safely, usefully and supportably by real users, and what must be true before production readiness can be assessed.

## 2. Activity 1: Confirm pilot operating plan, cohort and control boundary

### 2.1. Pilot start confirmation checklist

| Area                       | Confirmation question                                            | Status | Owner | Evidence / note |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------|-----------------|
| <b>Pilot objective</b>     | Is the pilot learning objective clear?                           |        |       |                 |
| <b>User cohort</b>         | Are pilot users and groups approved?                             |        |       |                 |
| <b>Access groups</b>       | Are roles, permissions and access routes confirmed?              |        |       |                 |
| <b>Supported questions</b> | Are supported question types clear?                              |        |       |                 |
| <b>Excluded questions</b>  | Are excluded / unsupported question types documented?            |        |       |                 |
| <b>Data scope</b>          | Are approved data assets and caveats confirmed?                  |        |       |                 |
| <b>Answer types</b>        | Are allowed answer formats defined?                              |        |       |                 |
| <b>Known limitations</b>   | Are limitations visible to users and support teams?              |        |       |                 |
| <b>Monitoring</b>          | Are usage, quality, cost, latency and risk signals available?    |        |       |                 |
| <b>Feedback route</b>      | Is feedback captured in a structured way and linkable to traces? |        |       |                 |
| <b>Support route</b>       | Is first-line and escalation support clear?                      |        |       |                 |
| <b>Pause conditions</b>    | Are stop / narrow / pause triggers explicit?                     |        |       |                 |
| <b>Change route</b>        | Is approval for quick fixes and material changes defined?        |        |       |                 |
| <b>Decision forum</b>      | Is the pilot review and final decision route agreed?             |        |       |                 |

Suggested status values: Ready / Ready with caveat / Gap / Blocked / Not applicable.

### 2.2. Pilot operating plan template

| Item                          | Description                                        |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pilot name</b>             | Name of the controlled pilot.                      |
| <b>Pilot objective</b>        | What the pilot is intended to learn or prove.      |
| <b>MVP version</b>            | Version of the validated MVP entering pilot.       |
| <b>Environment</b>            | Pilot / staging / controlled internal environment. |
| <b>Pilot start date</b>       | Planned start date.                                |
| <b>Planned review cadence</b> | Daily, twice weekly, weekly or milestone-based.    |
| <b>Planned pilot duration</b> | Directional duration and review points.            |
| <b>Pilot users</b>            | Named users or approved user groups.               |
| <b>Excluded users</b>         | Users or groups explicitly excluded.               |
| <b>Supported questions</b>    | Question types approved for pilot answering.       |

|                              |                                                                                 |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Unsupported questions</b> | Question types the system should refuse, clarify or redirect.                   |
| <b>Data assets in scope</b>  | Approved tables, views, semantic assets or APIs.                                |
| <b>Answer types in scope</b> | Number, table, chart, short narrative, caveated answer, clarification, refusal. |
| <b>Known limitations</b>     | Caveats users and support teams must understand.                                |
| <b>Usage limits</b>          | Query limits, concurrency limits, time windows or cost limits.                  |
| <b>Monitoring owner</b>      | Person or team reviewing pilot signals.                                         |
| <b>Support owner</b>         | Person or team handling user support.                                           |
| <b>Escalation route</b>      | Route for incidents, access issues, misleading answers or exposure concerns.    |
| <b>Change approver</b>       | Person or forum approving quick fixes and material changes.                     |
| <b>Pause authority</b>       | Person or forum empowered to pause, narrow or restart pilot usage.              |
| <b>Final decision owner</b>  | Person or forum deciding Phase 7 outcome.                                       |

## 2.3. Pilot boundary statement template

Purpose: create a short, plain-language statement of what the pilot covers and does not cover.

| Boundary area                  | Approved pilot boundary |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Users</b>                   |                         |
| <b>Business domain</b>         |                         |
| <b>Data assets</b>             |                         |
| <b>Supported questions</b>     |                         |
| <b>Unsupported questions</b>   |                         |
| <b>Supported answer types</b>  |                         |
| <b>Caveats / limitations</b>   |                         |
| <b>Access restrictions</b>     |                         |
| <b>Usage limits</b>            |                         |
| <b>Monitoring requirements</b> |                         |
| <b>Escalation conditions</b>   |                         |
| <b>Pause conditions</b>        |                         |

Example — illustrative:

| Boundary area                 | Approved pilot boundary                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Users</b>                  | 15 regional sales managers and 2 sales operations analysts.                                 |
| <b>Business domain</b>        | Sales performance and pipeline conversion.                                                  |
| <b>Data assets</b>            | sales_revenue_mart, region_dimension, pipeline_summary_view.                                |
| <b>Supported questions</b>    | Revenue by region, customer count by segment, pipeline conversion, month-on-month variance. |
| <b>Unsupported questions</b>  | Margin, individual salesperson performance, forecasting, customer profitability.            |
| <b>Supported answer types</b> | Number, table, short narrative, clarification, refusal.                                     |
| <b>Caveats / limitations</b>  | Current-month revenue is provisional; pipeline is refreshed daily, not real time.           |
| <b>Access restrictions</b>    | Users can only see their approved region.                                                   |
| <b>Usage limits</b>           | Internal pilot use only; no export for board, regulatory or external reporting.             |



|                                |                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Monitoring requirements</b> | Weekly review of usage, errors, refusals, latency, cost and support issues.              |
| <b>Escalation conditions</b>   | Possible data exposure, materially misleading answer, repeated unsupported use.          |
| <b>Pause conditions</b>        | Incorrect access enforcement, misleading answer in supported scope, audit trace failure. |

## 2.4. Pilot governance and decision route

| Decision type                  | Decision owner               | Evidence required                                                     | Typical timing         |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>Start pilot</b>             | Product owner / sponsor      | Phase 6 approval, pilot plan, user list, monitoring and support route | Before pilot start     |
| <b>Add pilot user</b>          | Product owner + access owner | Approved cohort, access check, onboarding confirmation                | During pilot           |
| <b>Release quick fix</b>       | Product / technical owner    | Fix note, test evidence, communication note                           | During pilot           |
| <b>Release material change</b> | Decision forum / risk owner  | Retest evidence, impact assessment, boundary update                   | Review point           |
| <b>Narrow pilot</b>            | Product owner + risk owner   | Issue evidence, affected users/questions/data                         | As needed              |
| <b>Pause affected scope</b>    | Pause authority              | Severity evidence, risk rationale, restart condition                  | Immediate where needed |
| <b>Restart affected scope</b>  | Pause authority              | Fix evidence, retest evidence, communication note                     | After remediation      |
| <b>Proceed to Phase 8</b>      | Decision forum               | Pilot learning pack, backlog, risk and supportability evidence        | End of pilot           |
| <b>Stop pilot</b>              | Sponsor / decision forum     | Value, risk, supportability or feasibility evidence                   | As needed              |

## 2.5. Pilot start meeting agenda

Purpose: confirm that the pilot can start without reopening earlier phase decisions.

- Confirm pilot objective and expected learning.
- Confirm approved users, access groups and excluded users.
- Confirm supported and unsupported questions.
- Confirm data assets, caveats and known limitations.
- Confirm user documentation and onboarding plan.
- Confirm support, monitoring and escalation route.
- Confirm quick-fix and material-change approval route.
- Confirm pause, narrow and restart authority.
- Confirm first review date and decision cadence.
- Confirm go / no-go to start controlled pilot.

## 2.6. Quick readiness decision record

| Item                                 | Decision                                  |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pilot start decision</b>          | Start / Start with caveats / Do not start |
| <b>Main caveats</b>                  |                                           |
| <b>Required actions before start</b> |                                           |
| <b>Accepted constraints</b>          |                                           |
| <b>First review point</b>            |                                           |
| <b>Decision owner</b>                |                                           |
| <b>Date</b>                          |                                           |

Example decision wording — illustrative:

The Phase 7 pilot may start for the approved regional sales cohort, limited to sales performance and pipeline questions. Margin, forecasting and salesperson-level questions remain out of scope. Current-month revenue caveats must be visible to users. Any access issue, misleading supported answer or missing trace should trigger immediate review and potential pause of the affected scope.

## 2.7. Common mistakes to avoid

| Mistake                                               | Why it matters                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Reopening the whole scope</b>                      | Activity 1 becomes a new planning phase instead of a readiness confirmation.       |
| <b>Starting with “friendly users” but no boundary</b> | Positive feedback becomes hard to interpret and risky behaviour may be normalised. |
| <b>Treating support as optional</b>                   | The pilot becomes dependent on the build team and does not test operability.       |
| <b>Allowing informal quick fixes</b>                  | Behaviour changes without traceability, retesting or user communication.           |
| <b>Not defining pause authority</b>                   | Everyone sees the issue, but nobody is empowered to stop or narrow exposure.       |
| <b>Missing unsupported-question handling</b>          | Natural user demand expands scope without approval.                                |

## 3. Activity 2: Prepare user, support and operator guidance

### 3.1. Documentation readiness checklist

| Documentation area             | Confirmation question                           | Minimum for small pilot      | Higher standard for larger pilot                                | Status | Owner |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------|
| <b>Pilot access</b>            | Do users know how to access the pilot?          | Link / access route shared   | Access guide with screenshots and troubleshooting               |        |       |
| <b>Connection / login</b>      | Is authentication clear?                        | Basic login instruction      | SSO, access group, MFA and issue route documented               |        |       |
| <b>UI basics</b>               | Do users know how to use the interface?         | Short quick-start note       | UI guide with examples and known limitations                    |        |       |
| <b>Supported questions</b>     | Are included question types clear?              | Short list of examples       | Supported-question catalogue by domain / answer type            |        |       |
| <b>Unsupported questions</b>   | Are exclusions clear?                           | Short list of examples       | Exclusion guide with refusal / redirect examples                |        |       |
| <b>Caveats</b>                 | Do users understand limitations?                | Key caveats visible          | Caveat guide with examples of interpretation risk               |        |       |
| <b>Responsible use</b>         | Do users know how not to misuse the pilot?      | Short do / don't list        | Responsible-use guidance and acknowledgement                    |        |       |
| <b>Feedback</b>                | Is the feedback route clear?                    | Feedback button / form       | Structured feedback linked to traces and issue categories       |        |       |
| <b>Escalation</b>              | Do users know when to escalate?                 | Named contact / channel      | Escalation route by issue severity                              |        |       |
| <b>Usage / cost limits</b>     | Are users aware of sensible usage expectations? | Simple usage rules           | Usage thresholds, cost guidance and heavy-use escalation        |        |       |
| <b>Support triage</b>          | Can support handle common issues?               | Short support note           | Support playbook with issue categories and escalation           |        |       |
| <b>Operator guidance</b>       | Can operators diagnose pilot behaviour?         | Known links to logs / traces | Operator runbook with monitoring, logs, pause and restart route |        |       |
| <b>Technical documentation</b> | Is technical documentation                      | Existing Phase 5/6           | Updated technical pack with known                               |        |       |

|  |                           |                 |                               |  |  |
|--|---------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------|--|--|
|  | usable for pilot support? | docs referenced | limitations and release notes |  |  |
|--|---------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------|--|--|

Suggested status values: Ready / Ready with caveat / Gap / Blocked / Not applicable.

## 3.2. Pilot user quick-start guide template

| Section                          | Content to provide                                                               |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What the pilot is for</b>     | Short description of the pilot objective and intended use.                       |
| <b>Who can use it</b>            | Approved users or user groups.                                                   |
| <b>How to access it</b>          | Link, access route, login method, browser / app requirements, connection steps.  |
| <b>How to use the UI</b>         | Basic steps: ask a question, refine, review sources / caveats, give feedback.    |
| <b>What you can ask</b>          | Supported domains, metrics, question types and examples.                         |
| <b>What is out of scope</b>      | Unsupported questions, excluded data, excluded answer types.                     |
| <b>How to read answers</b>       | How to interpret numbers, tables, caveats, sources, refusals and clarifications. |
| <b>How to use it responsibly</b> | When to verify, when not to rely on the answer, what not to use it for.          |
| <b>Usage expectations</b>        | Expected usage, discouraged heavy use, known latency or cost constraints.        |
| <b>How to give feedback</b>      | Feedback button, form, channel, what good feedback should include.               |
| <b>How to escalate</b>           | When and how to report access issues, wrong answers, missing data or incidents.  |
| <b>Known limitations</b>         | Current limitations users should understand before using the pilot.              |

## 3.3. Example user guidance — illustrative

What this pilot is for: This pilot helps approved regional sales managers ask questions about sales performance and pipeline conversion using the approved sales data assets.

How to access the pilot: Use the pilot link shared by the product owner. Access is restricted to approved pilot users. If you cannot connect or see the expected region, contact the pilot support channel.

Good questions:

- “What was revenue last month by region?”
- “Show pipeline conversion by segment for Q2.”
- “How did customer count change month on month?”

Unsupported questions:

- Margin or profitability questions.
- Individual salesperson performance.
- Forecasting or future revenue predictions.

Questions outside the approved sales performance data scope.

- How to interpret answers  
Review caveats before using an answer. Current-month revenue may be provisional.

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Pipeline data is refreshed daily, not in real time. If an answer looks surprising, ask a follow-up, check the caveat or escalate.

Responsible use: Do not use pilot outputs for external reporting, board packs, regulatory submissions or contractual decisions. The pilot is intended to test controlled internal use.

Usage and cost expectations: Use the pilot for real workflow questions, not high-volume exploration or repeated broad queries. Heavy or unusual usage may be reviewed if it creates cost, latency or support issues.

Feedback: Use the feedback option after useful, wrong, confusing or unsupported answers. Feedback should describe what you expected and whether the answer helped the workflow.

### 3.4. Supported and unsupported question examples

| Question                                          | Expected system behaviour                                    | User guidance note                               |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>“What was revenue last month by region?”</b>   | Answer if within approved scope and user access.             | Supported question. Review caveats.              |
| <b>“Show revenue for my region this quarter.”</b> | Answer using user access boundary.                           | Supported if region access is correctly applied. |
| <b>“What is margin by product?”</b>               | Refuse or redirect if margin is out of scope.                | Unsupported for current pilot.                   |
| <b>“Which salesperson performed worst?”</b>       | Refuse if individual performance is excluded.                | Not supported due to scope and sensitivity.      |
| <b>“Forecast next quarter revenue.”</b>           | Refuse or clarify if forecasting is excluded.                | Not validated for pilot use.                     |
| <b>“Why did revenue fall?”</b>                    | Clarify or provide bounded descriptive analysis if approved. | Avoid unsupported causal claims.                 |
| <b>“Export all customer-level data.”</b>          | Refuse if row-level export is not approved.                  | Data exposure risk.                              |
| <b>“Can I use this in the board pack?”</b>        | Explain pilot limitation and escalation route.               | Pilot output is not production-approved.         |

### 3.5. Support guide template

| Support area                          | What support should know                                                    | Escalation route                          |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Access issue</b>                   | User cannot connect, wrong role, wrong region or missing permission.        | Access owner / security lead.             |
| <b>UI issue</b>                       | User cannot submit question, view answer, provide feedback or load session. | Product / application owner.              |
| <b>Unsupported question</b>           | User asks outside approved boundary.                                        | Product owner for backlog classification. |
| <b>Suspected wrong answer</b>         | Answer appears incorrect, misleading or inconsistent.                       | Evaluation owner + data / semantic owner. |
| <b>Caveat confusion</b>               | User misunderstands limitation, source or answer wording.                   | Product owner + SME.                      |
| <b>Data freshness issue</b>           | Data appears stale, incomplete or inconsistent.                             | Data owner / analytics engineer.          |
| <b>Refusal or clarification issue</b> | System refuses incorrectly or asks poor clarification.                      | AI / solution architect.                  |

|                                  |                                                                          |                                         |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Cost or latency issue</b>     | Query or answer is slow, expensive or repeated.                          | Technical owner / operating owner.      |
| <b>Possible exposure issue</b>   | User sees data they should not see or system reveals restricted content. | Security / governance lead immediately. |
| <b>Incident or pause trigger</b> | Issue may require narrowing or pausing pilot usage.                      | Pilot decision owner / pause authority. |

### 3.6. Operator and technical documentation checklist

| Area                                 | Documentation required                                                        | Available? | Location / owner | Gap |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------------|-----|
| <b>MVP version and release notes</b> | Current pilot version, changes since validation, known fixes.                 |            |                  |     |
| <b>Architecture overview</b>         | High-level flow: UI, model, retrieval, validation, execution, logging.        |            |                  |     |
| <b>Data and metadata scope</b>       | Approved assets, metadata sources, caveats and exclusions.                    |            |                  |     |
| <b>Access model</b>                  | User groups, permissions, row / column rules and access lifecycle.            |            |                  |     |
| <b>Logging and traces</b>            | Where prompts, retrieval, SQL, validation, answers and feedback are logged.   |            |                  |     |
| <b>Monitoring views</b>              | Usage, error, refusal, cost, latency and support dashboards.                  |            |                  |     |
| <b>Known limitations</b>             | Known technical, data, semantic, model or support limitations.                |            |                  |     |
| <b>Support procedures</b>            | Common issue diagnosis and escalation routes.                                 |            |                  |     |
| <b>Pause and restart route</b>       | How affected users, questions, data or the pilot can be paused and restarted. |            |                  |     |
| <b>Change process</b>                | Quick fix, hot fix and material change approval and release process.          |            |                  |     |
| <b>Retest evidence</b>               | Required evidence after changes before affected usage resumes.                |            |                  |     |
| <b>Incident record</b>               | Where incidents, decisions, owners and follow-up actions are captured.        |            |                  |     |

### 3.7. Usage and cost guidance template

| Area                            | Guidance to define                                                                            |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Expected use</b>             | What normal pilot use looks like by user or cohort.                                           |
| <b>Discouraged use</b>          | Repeated broad queries, high-volume exploration, unsupported requests, unnecessary refreshes. |
| <b>Query limits</b>             | Any limits on question frequency, concurrency, result size, exports or time windows.          |
| <b>Cost-sensitive behaviour</b> | Question patterns likely to increase model, query or infrastructure cost.                     |
| <b>Latency expectations</b>     | Typical response time and what users should do when the system is slow.                       |
| <b>Heavy-use review</b>         | When unusual usage is reviewed and by whom.                                                   |

|                         |                                                                     |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Escalation route</b> | Who to contact for slow, expensive, repeated or blocked queries.    |
| <b>Communication</b>    | How usage limits or cost-related changes are communicated to users. |

Example — illustrative:

| Area                            | Guidance                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Expected use</b>             | Use the pilot for real sales performance questions during weekly trading review preparation.   |
| <b>Discouraged use</b>          | Do not run repeated broad “all regions / all customers / all periods” queries for exploration. |
| <b>Query limits</b>             | Exports and customer-level extracts are not available in the pilot.                            |
| <b>Cost-sensitive behaviour</b> | Repeated wide date-range questions may create unnecessary warehouse and model cost.            |
| <b>Heavy-use review</b>         | Usage patterns are reviewed weekly by the product owner and operating owner.                   |
| <b>Escalation route</b>         | Report repeated slow responses through the pilot support channel.                              |

### 3.8. Onboarding session agenda

- Explain pilot objective and approved boundary.
- Show how to access the pilot and use the UI.
- Walk through supported and unsupported question examples.
- Explain caveats, refusals, clarifications and safe failure.
- Explain responsible use, usage expectations and cost / latency considerations.
- Show how to give feedback and what useful feedback looks like.
- Explain support and escalation route.
- Confirm known limitations and pause conditions.
- Capture user questions and documentation gaps.
- Confirm user is ready to start pilot use.

### 3.9. Documentation gap log

| Gap | Affected audience           | Risk | Owner | Decision                                               | Target date |
|-----|-----------------------------|------|-------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
|     | Users / support / operators |      |       | Fix before pilot / accept for pilot / defer / escalate |             |

Example — illustrative:

| Gap                                                      | Affected audience | Risk                                          | Owner           | Decision               | Target date |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Caveat wording unclear for current-month revenue.</b> | Users             | Users may treat provisional numbers as final. | Product owner   | Fix before pilot.      |             |
| <b>Support cannot access trace dashboard.</b>            | Support           | Support depends on build team for diagnosis.  | Operating owner | Fix before pilot.      |             |
| <b>Cost guidance not included in quick-start note.</b>   | Users             | Users may create avoidable broad queries.     | Product owner   | Add before onboarding. |             |

## 4. Activity 3: Test pilot access, onboarding, role changes and offboarding

### 4.1. Pilot access lifecycle test plan

| Scenario                             | Purpose                                                       | Test user / role | Expected behaviour                                         | Expected timing | Evidence required                              | Status |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------|--------|
| <b>New user onboarding</b>           | Confirm approved users can access the pilot.                  |                  | User can connect and sees only approved scope.             |                 | Login, access group, trace sample.             |        |
| <b>Existing user access check</b>    | Confirm current pilot users still have correct access.        |                  | User sees correct data boundary and allowed answer types.  |                 | Access test, query / answer trace.             |        |
| <b>Role change</b>                   | Confirm changed role updates access and answer boundary.      |                  | System reflects new role and old access no longer applies. |                 | Before / after access evidence.                |        |
| <b>Region / business unit change</b> | Confirm row-level boundary changes correctly.                 |                  | User sees only new approved region / unit.                 |                 | Query evidence showing applied filter.         |        |
| <b>Permission revocation</b>         | Confirm restricted capability or data access is removed.      |                  | User cannot access removed scope.                          |                 | Refusal, denied access or blocked query trace. |        |
| <b>Pilot offboarding</b>             | Confirm user removed from pilot can no longer access the MVP. |                  | User cannot connect or query.                              |                 | Access removal evidence.                       |        |
| <b>Leaver scenario</b>               | Confirm joiner / mover / leaver process works where relevant. |                  | Access is removed through normal identity route.           |                 | IAM / access log and system check.             |        |

Suggested status values: Planned / Tested / Passed / Passed with caveat / Failed / Not tested / Not applicable.



## 4.2. Access-change timing record

| Scenario                             | Approval time | Provisioning time | Permission sync time | App / cache refresh time | Total observed time | Expected timing met? | Notes |
|--------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------|----------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|----------------------|-------|
| <b>Add new pilot user</b>            |               |                   |                      |                          |                     | Yes / No / N/A       |       |
| <b>Change user role</b>              |               |                   |                      |                          |                     | Yes / No / N/A       |       |
| <b>Change region / business unit</b> |               |                   |                      |                          |                     | Yes / No / N/A       |       |
| <b>Revoke permission</b>             |               |                   |                      |                          |                     | Yes / No / N/A       |       |
| <b>Remove pilot access</b>           |               |                   |                      |                          |                     | Yes / No / N/A       |       |

Practical note: for a small POC, expected timings may be informal or manually handled. If the pilot is on a path to production, expected and observed timings should be measured and carried into Phase 8 as access-administration evidence.

## 4.3. Access boundary test matrix

| User / group                    | Approved data scope    | Question asked         | Expected access behaviour        | Actual behaviour | Pass / fail | Evidence |
|---------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------|-------------|----------|
| <b>Regional sales manager</b>   | Own region only        | Revenue by region      | Answer only for approved region. |                  |             |          |
| <b>Sales operations analyst</b> | All regions            | Revenue by region      | Answer all approved regions.     |                  |             |          |
| <b>Removed pilot user</b>       | No access              | Any question           | Access blocked.                  |                  |             |          |
| <b>Changed role user</b>        | New approved role only | Prior-scope question   | Old scope unavailable.           |                  |             |          |
| <b>Restricted data user</b>     | No sensitive data      | Customer-level request | Refuse or block query.           |                  |             |          |

## 4.4. Traceability evidence checklist

Testing access lifecycle requires enough traceability to confirm which boundary was applied at runtime.

| Evidence item                                  | Why it matters                                        | Available? | Location / owner | Restriction |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------------|-------------|
| <b>User identifier or pseudonymous user ID</b> | Confirms who asked the question.                      |            |                  |             |
| <b>User role / access group at query time</b>  | Confirms permission context.                          |            |                  |             |
| <b>Question text or redacted question text</b> | Confirms intent and scope.                            |            |                  |             |
| <b>Retrieved metadata / policy context</b>     | Shows what the system used to ground the answer.      |            |                  |             |
| <b>Generated query or tool call</b>            | Confirms table, filter, row limit and access logic.   |            |                  |             |
| <b>Validation result</b>                       | Shows whether query / access checks passed or failed. |            |                  |             |
| <b>Final answer or answer summary</b>          | Confirms what the user saw.                           |            |                  |             |
| <b>Caveats / refusal message</b>               | Confirms boundary communication.                      |            |                  |             |
| <b>Timestamp and system version</b>            | Links result to release, model and policy version.    |            |                  |             |
| <b>Feedback / support ticket link</b>          | Links user issue to trace evidence.                   |            |                  |             |

For sensitive data, broad access to raw logs may not be appropriate. Use restricted log access, redacted traces, pseudonymised user identifiers, query summaries or controlled audit views where needed.

## 4.5. Example access lifecycle test — illustrative

| Item                               | Example                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Scenario</b>                    | Regional sales manager moves from North region to South region.                                                 |
| <b>Expected behaviour</b>          | User should no longer see North region results and should only see South region data after permission sync.     |
| <b>Expected timing</b>             | Same day after IAM group update and application cache refresh.                                                  |
| <b>Test question before change</b> | “Show revenue for my region last month.”                                                                        |
| <b>Test question after change</b>  | “Show revenue for my region last month.”                                                                        |
| <b>Evidence required</b>           | User role before / after, applied region filter, generated query or query summary, final answer, timestamp.     |
| <b>Pass condition</b>              | Answer uses South region filter after change and North region is no longer accessible.                          |
| <b>Failure pattern</b>             | User continues to see North region data after role change, or answer combines both regions without explanation. |

## 4.6. Access exception and workaround log

| Issue | Scenario                                            | Impact | Temporary workaround | Risk | Owner | Decision                                    | Phase 8 implication |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------|----------------------|------|-------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------|
|       | Onboarding / role change / offboarding / revocation |        |                      |      |       | Accept / Fix / Constrain / Pause / Escalate |                     |

Example — illustrative:

| Issue                                            | Scenario      | Impact                                                   | Temporary workaround             | Risk                                 | Owner           | Decision                          | Phase 8 implication                              |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Role changes require manual app refresh.</b>  | Region change | Access update not visible immediately.                   | Build team refreshes user cache. | Stale permissions during transition. | Technical owner | Accept for pilot with monitoring. | Production needs automated refresh or clear SLA. |
| <b>Support cannot view redacted query trace.</b> | Access issue  | Support cannot diagnose whether issue is access or data. | Escalate to build team.          | Slow incident handling.              | Operating owner | Fix before broader pilot.         | Support trace view required before production.   |

## 4.7. Minimum evidence by delivery intent

| Delivery intent                    | Minimum expectation                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Small POC / expert test</b>     | Manual user provisioning may be acceptable if documented as a shortcut. Basic access checks should still confirm users see only intended data.               |
| <b>Controlled business pilot</b>   | Onboarding, access boundary and at least one role / access change scenario should be tested or simulated. Support should know how to escalate access issues. |
| <b>Production-path MVP</b>         | Joiner, mover, leaver, revocation, role-change and permission-sync behaviour should be tested with timing evidence, traceability and named owners.           |
| <b>Sensitive / regulated scope</b> | Access testing should include redacted or restricted trace review, audit evidence, stale-permission checks and clear pause conditions.                       |

## 4.8. Common mistakes to avoid

| Mistake                            | Why it matters                                                                               |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Testing only initial access</b> | The pilot may work on day one but fail when users change role, leave or need access removed. |
| <b>Ignoring propagation timing</b> | Access may be “correct eventually” but unsafe during the transition period.                  |

|                                                     |                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Relying on the build team to provision users</b> | This may be acceptable for a POC, but it is not production evidence unless documented as a shortcut. |
| <b>No access to traces</b>                          | Support cannot prove whether the right data boundary, query or refusal was applied.                  |
| <b>Logging sensitive data too broadly</b>           | Access testing should not create a new exposure risk through unrestricted logs.                      |
| <b>Not testing offboarding</b>                      | Removed users may retain pilot access longer than expected.                                          |
| <b>No Phase 8 carry-forward</b>                     | Manual workarounds and timing gaps are forgotten instead of becoming production-readiness items.     |

## 5. Activity 4: Run controlled pilot usage and monitored sessions

### 5.1. Pilot usage plan

| Area                            | Decision / description                                                              |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pilot usage objective</b>    | What the usage period is intended to test or learn.                                 |
| <b>User cohort</b>              | Approved users or groups participating in the pilot.                                |
| <b>User mix</b>                 | Expert users, normal users, champions, sponsors, occasional users, support users.   |
| <b>Workflow context</b>         | Real workflow, meeting, reporting cycle, analyst request, decision process or task. |
| <b>Usage mode</b>               | Self-service use, facilitated session, monitored session or mixed approach.         |
| <b>Expected usage frequency</b> | Daily, weekly, event-driven, reporting-cycle driven or ad hoc.                      |
| <b>Pilot duration</b>           | Planned window and review points.                                                   |
| <b>Monitoring owner</b>         | Person or team reviewing usage and behaviour.                                       |
| <b>Session facilitator</b>      | Person supporting monitored sessions, if used.                                      |
| <b>Evidence captured</b>        | Questions, traces, feedback, observations, support tickets, errors, caveats.        |
| <b>Main caveats</b>             | Known limits in user mix, workflow coverage, timing or usage realism.               |

### 5.2. User cohort realism check

| User type                                        | Included? | Why included / excluded | Evidence caveat |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Primary target users</b>                      |           |                         |                 |
| <b>Expert users</b>                              |           |                         |                 |
| <b>Normal business users</b>                     |           |                         |                 |
| <b>Sponsors / champions</b>                      |           |                         |                 |
| <b>Skeptical or low-adoption users</b>           |           |                         |                 |
| <b>Support / operator users</b>                  |           |                         |                 |
| <b>Users with different access scopes</b>        |           |                         |                 |
| <b>Users with different data literacy levels</b> |           |                         |                 |

Example — illustrative:

| User type                    | Included? | Why included / excluded                       | Evidence caveat                                   |
|------------------------------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sponsors / champions</b>  | Yes       | They are available and close to the use case. | Positive feedback may overstate broader adoption. |
| <b>Normal business users</b> | Partially | Two users included from target team.          | Limited evidence on wider user behaviour.         |
| <b>Skeptical users</b>       | No        | Not available during pilot window.            | Trust and adoption risks may be under-tested.     |

|                                           |     |                                      |                                     |
|-------------------------------------------|-----|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Users with different access scopes</b> | Yes | Regional and central users included. | Useful for access-boundary testing. |
|-------------------------------------------|-----|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|

### 5.3. Monitored session plan

| Session | User / role | Workflow task | Questions to try                                        | Observation focus | Facilitator | Evidence                          |
|---------|-------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------|-----------------------------------|
|         |             |               | Natural questions / prepared task / follow-up questions |                   |             | Trace / feedback / notes / ticket |

Suggested observation focus:

- Does the user know what to ask?
- Does the question fit the approved boundary?
- Does the system clarify, answer, refuse or redirect appropriately?
- Does the user understand the answer and caveats?
- Does the user challenge surprising outputs?
- Does the user know how to give feedback or escalate?
- Does the user rely on the answer appropriately?
- Does the session reveal workflow friction, UI friction or support needs?

### 5.4. Real-use observation template

| Field                                      | Notes                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>User / role</b>                         |                                                                            |
| <b>Workflow context</b>                    |                                                                            |
| <b>Question asked</b>                      |                                                                            |
| <b>Supported / unsupported / ambiguous</b> |                                                                            |
| <b>System response</b>                     | Answer / clarification / refusal / redirect / error.                       |
| <b>User interpretation</b>                 | Did the user understand the answer, caveat and boundary?                   |
| <b>User action</b>                         | Used answer / challenged answer / abandoned / escalated / asked follow-up. |
| <b>Friction observed</b>                   | UI, wording, data, latency, access, caveat, support or workflow issue.     |
| <b>Feedback captured?</b>                  | Yes / No.                                                                  |
| <b>Trace linked?</b>                       | Yes / No / Not available.                                                  |
| <b>Issue candidate?</b>                    | Product / data / semantic / access / user education / support / process.   |
| <b>Follow-up action</b>                    |                                                                            |

### 5.5. Outside-scope question log

| Question | User role | Why outside scope           | System behaviour      | Correct behaviour? | Backlog implication              |
|----------|-----------|-----------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|----------------------------------|
|          |           | Unsupported metric / data / | Refused / clarified / | Yes / No           | Ignore / user education / future |

|  |  |                                    |                                         |  |                                 |
|--|--|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------|
|  |  | answer type /<br>access / workflow | redirected /<br>answered<br>incorrectly |  | scope /<br>remediate /<br>pause |
|--|--|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------|

Example — illustrative:

| Question                             | User role        | Why outside scope                | System behaviour                | Correct behaviour? | Backlog implication                |
|--------------------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------|
| “What is margin by product?”         | Sales manager    | Margin not approved for pilot.   | Refused and explained boundary. | Yes                | Log as future demand.              |
| “Which salesperson performed worst?” | Regional manager | Individual performance excluded. | Clarified then refused.         | Yes                | Reinforce guidance.                |
| “Forecast revenue next quarter.”     | Sponsor          | Forecasting not validated.       | Gave descriptive trend only.    | Partial            | Review wording and refusal policy. |

## 5.6. Pilot behaviour evidence log

| Behaviour observed                            | Example / evidence | Risk                           | Decision                              |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| User asks supported questions naturally       |                    | Positive workflow-fit signal   | Continue / monitor                    |
| User repeatedly asks outside scope            |                    | Guidance or demand-scope issue | Educate / log / narrow / backlog      |
| User ignores caveats                          |                    | Over-trust risk                | Improve answer format / onboarding    |
| User challenges surprising answer             |                    | Good trust calibration         | Capture as positive evidence          |
| User cannot connect system output to workflow |                    | Workflow-fit risk              | Review use case / user cohort         |
| User needs build-team coaching                |                    | Supportability issue           | Improve documentation / support route |
| User abandons due to latency                  |                    | Adoption and operational risk  | Monitor / optimise / constrain        |
| User creates high-cost broad queries          |                    | Cost and performance risk      | Add usage guidance / limit / monitor  |

## 5.7. Facilitator guidance for monitored sessions

| Do                                                        | Avoid                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Ask users to complete realistic workflow tasks.           | Steering users only toward questions known to work.  |
| Let users phrase questions naturally.                     | Rewriting every question for them.                   |
| Observe confusion, hesitation and misuse.                 | Treating confusion as a training inconvenience only. |
| Capture where users misunderstand caveats or boundaries.  | Explaining away every issue during the session.      |
| Link observations to traces, feedback or support tickets. | Relying only on meeting notes.                       |

|                                                                     |                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Record when the user cohort is unusually expert or friendly.</b> | Presenting champion-user evidence as representative adoption. |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|

## 5.8. Evidence caveat statement template

Use this when the pilot user group is not fully representative.

Pilot findings should be interpreted with caution because the user cohort was weighted towards [sponsors / expert users / motivated champions / a narrow role group]. This provides useful evidence on [workflow value / feasibility / high-intent usage / early adoption], but may under-test [normal user behaviour / low-trust users / wider support load / onboarding friction / misunderstood caveats]. These limitations should be considered before broader rollout or production-readiness decisions.

**Example — illustrative:** Pilot findings should be interpreted with caution because the user cohort was weighted towards motivated sales operations users and the commercial sponsor. This provides useful evidence on high-intent usage and workflow value, but may under-test normal sales-manager behaviour, onboarding friction and wider support load. These limitations should be considered before broader rollout.

## 5.9. Session summary template

| Item                             | Summary                   |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Session date</b>              |                           |
| <b>Users involved</b>            |                           |
| <b>Workflow tested</b>           |                           |
| <b>Number of questions asked</b> |                           |
| <b>Supported questions</b>       |                           |
| <b>Unsupported questions</b>     |                           |
| <b>Clarifications / refusals</b> |                           |
| <b>Main positive signals</b>     |                           |
| <b>Main issues observed</b>      |                           |
| <b>Trace coverage</b>            | Full / partial / missing. |
| <b>Support issues raised</b>     |                           |
| <b>Follow-up actions</b>         |                           |

## 5.10. Common mistakes to avoid

| Mistake                                                  | Why it matters                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Using only friendly users</b>                         | Feedback may overstate adoption, trust and usability.                               |
| <b>Running only scripted questions</b>                   | The pilot does not test real boundary handling or natural user behaviour.           |
| <b>Treating facilitation as normal use</b>               | A heavily coached session may hide usability and support issues.                    |
| <b>Not logging outside-scope demand</b>                  | Future scope and user-education needs are lost.                                     |
| <b>Capturing feedback without traces</b>                 | The team cannot diagnose whether the issue is user, data, model, access or product. |
| <b>Ignoring workflow context</b>                         | A technically correct answer may still not help the real task.                      |
| <b>Presenting narrow-user evidence as representative</b> | Phase 8 may underestimate onboarding, support and adoption risk.                    |



## 6. Activity 5: Capture feedback and link it to traces, users and question types

### 6.1. Feedback capture routes

| Route                            | Best use                                                     | Watch-outs                                               |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>In-product feedback</b>       | Immediate reaction to a specific answer.                     | Must capture trace ID or interaction ID.                 |
| <b>Support channel</b>           | Access issues, incidents, confusion, repeated problems.      | Often lacks question / answer context unless requested.  |
| <b>Monitored sessions</b>        | Rich qualitative observation.                                | May overstate usability because users are being coached. |
| <b>Short user interviews</b>     | Workflow fit, trust, unmet needs and adoption barriers.      | Needs to be linked back to actual usage where possible.  |
| <b>Usage-triggered follow-up</b> | Distinctive usage patterns: high, low, unusual or risky use. | Requires usage monitoring and agreed contact route.      |
| <b>Review meeting</b>            | Pattern review across users, questions and issues.           | Can become anecdotal if not trace-linked.                |

### 6.2. Feedback-to-trace register

| Feedback ID | User / role | Date / time | Question type                       | User feedback | Trace linked?      | Issue category                                                          | Severity | Owner | Decision                                                |
|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|---------------------------------------------------------|
|             |             |             | Supported / unsupported / ambiguous |               | Yes / No / Partial | Product / data / semantic / access / user education / support / process |          |       | Fix / educate / backlog / constrain / pause / no action |

Suggested issue categories:

- Product / UI issue.
- Data gap or freshness issue.
- Semantic ambiguity or metric-definition issue.
- Access or permission issue.
- Unsupported-scope demand.
- User education or documentation issue.
- Support or operating process issue.
- Model / orchestration issue.
- Cost, latency or performance issue.

### 6.3. Feedback quality checklist

| Question                                                    | Why it matters                                                                 | Status |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Is the feedback linked to a specific interaction?           | Avoids acting on vague comments.                                               |        |
| Is the user role or cohort known?                           | Helps interpret access, skill level and workflow relevance.                    |        |
| Is the question type captured?                              | Separates supported-scope quality from unsupported demand.                     |        |
| Is the system response available?                           | Enables diagnosis of answer, caveat, refusal or clarification behaviour.       |        |
| Is the generated query or tool call available where needed? | Helps diagnose data, semantic and access issues.                               |        |
| Is the user's expected answer or outcome known?             | Explains whether the issue is correctness, usefulness or expectation mismatch. |        |
| Is there a decision route?                                  | Ensures feedback becomes triage input, not a comment archive.                  |        |

### 6.4. Structured feedback form template

| Field               | Prompt                                                                          |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| User role           | What is your role or user group?                                                |
| Workflow context    | What were you trying to do?                                                     |
| Question asked      | What did you ask the system?                                                    |
| Answer usefulness   | Did the answer help your task? Yes / Partly / No.                               |
| Answer trust        | Did you trust the answer? Why / why not?                                        |
| Caveat clarity      | Were limitations or caveats clear?                                              |
| Issue type          | Wrong / confusing / incomplete / unsupported / too slow / access issue / other. |
| Expected outcome    | What answer or behaviour did you expect?                                        |
| Action taken        | Used answer / verified / escalated / ignored / asked follow-up.                 |
| Additional comments | Free text.                                                                      |

### 6.5. Distinctive usage follow-up list

Real-life feedback is often sparse. Use monitoring signals to identify users worth following up with.

| Signal                     | Possible interpretation                                                          | Follow-up question                                                 |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Very high usage            | Strong value, curiosity, misuse, broad exploration or support dependency.        | What are you using it for, and which outputs affect your workflow? |
| Very low usage             | Poor workflow fit, low trust, access friction, unclear value or weak onboarding. | What stopped you from using it?                                    |
| Many unsupported questions | Scope mismatch, unclear guidance or demand for future expansion.                 | Were you aware those questions were out of scope?                  |
| Many refusals              | Good boundary enforcement or poor scope fit.                                     | Did the refusal help you understand what to do next?               |

|                                       |                                                          |                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>No feedback despite high usage</b> | Feedback friction or overconfidence.                     | Did you encounter anything confusing, risky or surprisingly useful? |
| <b>Repeated access issues</b>         | Lifecycle, permissions or onboarding weakness.           | What happened, and how quickly was it resolved?                     |
| <b>Long or expensive sessions</b>     | Broad queries, unclear user intent or cost-risk pattern. | Were you exploring broadly or trying to answer a specific task?     |
| <b>Frequent follow-ups</b>            | Useful exploration or initial answers not clear enough.  | Did follow-ups help, or were you compensating for unclear answers?  |

## 6.6. Positive-value evidence template

Positive feedback should be linked to real workflow value, not only satisfaction.

| User / role | Workflow | Question / interaction | Value observed                                                                                                   | Evidence                                    | Caveat |
|-------------|----------|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------|
|             |          |                        | Faster answer / better exploration / reduced analyst dependency / improved consistency / better decision support | Trace / feedback / interview / session note |        |

Example — illustrative:

| User / role                   | Workflow              | Question / interaction                     | Value observed                                                               | Evidence                                             | Caveat                                                               |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Regional sales manager</b> | Weekly trading review | Revenue and pipeline conversion by segment | Reduced preparation time and enabled follow-up questions during review prep. | Trace IDs, user feedback and monitored session note. | User is a motivated pilot champion; broader adoption not yet proven. |

## 6.7. Feedback diagnosis guide

| User says...                     | Do not assume...            | Check...                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>"The answer is wrong."</b>    | The model failed.           | Data source, metric definition, filter, access boundary, generated query and user expectation. |
| <b>"I do not trust it."</b>      | The answer is wrong.        | Caveat clarity, source visibility, prior user experience and sensitivity of workflow.          |
| <b>"It refused my question."</b> | Refusal is a bug.           | Whether the question was unsupported, ambiguous, unsafe or outside access rights.              |
| <b>"It is too slow."</b>         | The UI is slow.             | Model calls, query execution, retrieval, validation, network and result size.                  |
| <b>"This is useful."</b>         | Production value is proven. | Which workflow it helped, frequency, risk level and whether the user is representative.        |
| <b>"I stopped using it."</b>     | The use case has no value.  | Onboarding, trust, timing, workflow fit, access friction and competing tools.                  |
| <b>"I need more data."</b>       | Scope should expand now.    | Whether the request belongs in pilot, Phase 8 backlog or later enhancement.                    |

## 6.8. Feedback review cadence

| Cadence                                       | Review focus                                                                                   | Participants                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Daily or near-daily during early pilot</b> | Blocking issues, access problems, misleading answers, exposure risks, support load.            | Product, support, technical owner, security where needed.          |
| <b>Weekly</b>                                 | Usage patterns, feedback themes, unsupported demand, quick fixes, backlog and caveat updates.  | Product, business SME, support, evaluation, data / semantic owner. |
| <b>End-of-pilot</b>                           | Value, trust, workflow fit, supportability, risk, Phase 8 backlog and decision recommendation. | Decision forum and accountable owners.                             |

## 6.9. Feedback summary template

| Area                                 | Summary                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Feedback volume</b>               | Number of feedback items by source.                                      |
| <b>Trace linkage</b>                 | Share of material feedback linked to trace / interaction evidence.       |
| <b>Main positive signals</b>         | Workflow value, adoption signals, trusted use, useful safe failure.      |
| <b>Main negative signals</b>         | Wrong, confusing, unsupported, slow, inaccessible or risky interactions. |
| <b>Distinctive users followed up</b> | High usage, low usage, repeated refusals, repeated unsupported demand.   |
| <b>Unsupported demand</b>            | Question types users wanted but pilot does not support.                  |
| <b>User education gaps</b>           | Misunderstood caveats, unclear scope, responsible-use issues.            |
| <b>Support implications</b>          | Issues support could / could not diagnose.                               |
| <b>Backlog implications</b>          | Fix now, constrain, Phase 8, later enhancement, no action.               |

## 6.10. Common mistakes to avoid

| Mistake                                               | Why it matters                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Relying on satisfaction scores</b>                 | Users may like a tool they misuse or over-trust.                                           |
| <b>Collecting feedback without trace IDs</b>          | The team cannot diagnose what actually happened.                                           |
| <b>Treating unsupported demand as product failure</b> | Scope expansion becomes uncontrolled.                                                      |
| <b>Ignoring silent users</b>                          | Low or no usage may reveal weak value, poor onboarding or low trust.                       |
| <b>Treating champion feedback as representative</b>   | Positive findings may not generalise to normal users.                                      |
| <b>Not following up with distinctive users</b>        | The most informative patterns often sit at the extremes of usage.                          |
| <b>Capturing complaints but not expected outcomes</b> | The team cannot tell whether the issue is correctness, usefulness or expectation mismatch. |
| <b>Letting feedback bypass triage</b>                 | Issues become anecdotes instead of controlled pilot evidence.                              |

## 7. Activity 6: Monitor usage, trust, errors, refusals, escalations, cost and latency

### 7.1. Pilot monitoring dashboard structure

| Area                   | Signal to monitor                                        | Why it matters                              | Typical owner              |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>Usage</b>           | Active users, questions asked, sessions, follow-ups      | Shows adoption and interaction pattern      | Product owner              |
| <b>User mix</b>        | Usage by role, cohort, region or access group            | Shows whether evidence is representative    | Product owner              |
| <b>Question types</b>  | Supported, unsupported, ambiguous, repeated              | Separates value from scope pressure         | Product / evaluation owner |
| <b>Trust behaviour</b> | Verification, caveat use, escalation, abandoned sessions | Shows whether users trust appropriately     | Product / SME              |
| <b>Errors</b>          | Failed queries, timeouts, empty results, UI errors       | Identifies reliability and usability issues | Technical owner            |
| <b>Refusals</b>        | Refusal volume and refusal appropriateness               | Tests boundary handling                     | Evaluation owner           |
| <b>Clarifications</b>  | Clarification frequency and completion                   | Tests ambiguity handling                    | AI / solution architect    |
| <b>Support</b>         | Tickets, questions, incidents, recurring confusion       | Tests supportability                        | Support owner              |
| <b>Access</b>          | Denied access, wrong scope, permission issues            | Tests access lifecycle and exposure risk    | Security / access owner    |
| <b>Cost</b>            | Model cost, query cost, infrastructure cost              | Tests economic sustainability               | Operating owner            |
| <b>Latency</b>         | End-to-end response time and step-level delay            | Tests usability and scale assumptions       | Technical owner            |
| <b>Risk events</b>     | Misleading answer, exposure concern, repeated misuse     | Triggers triage, constraint or pause        | Risk / decision owner      |

### 7.2. Usage-pattern review

| Pattern                                      | Possible interpretation                              | Follow-up action                        |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Sustained use by representative users</b> | Strong value pull and workflow relevance             | Assess hardening and Phase 8 scope      |
| <b>High use by champions only</b>            | Useful signal, but adoption may be overstated        | Caveat evidence and test broader users  |
| <b>Low use across all users</b>              | Poor fit, weak onboarding, low trust or wrong timing | Interview users and review workflow fit |
| <b>High initial use then drop-off</b>        | Curiosity spike, disappointing value or friction     | Review question types and user feedback |
| <b>Heavy use by one cohort</b>               | Strong local value or excessive dependency           | Review support and cost impact          |
| <b>Many follow-up questions</b>              | Useful exploration or unclear first answers          | Review answer quality and UX            |

|                                       |                                     |                                   |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Repeated unsupported questions</b> | Scope mismatch or unclear guidance  | Update guidance or backlog demand |
| <b>No feedback despite high usage</b> | Feedback friction or overconfidence | Follow up directly with users     |

### 7.3. Trust and responsible-use indicators

| Indicator               | Positive signal                                     | Risk signal                                                   |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Caveat behaviour</b> | Users read and act on caveats                       | Users ignore caveats or treat caveated answers as final       |
| <b>Verification</b>     | Users verify surprising outputs                     | Users rely on surprising answers without challenge            |
| <b>Escalation</b>       | Users escalate unclear or risky answers             | Users do not know when or how to escalate                     |
| <b>Refusal handling</b> | Users understand why refusal happened               | Users repeatedly try to bypass refusals                       |
| <b>Follow-up use</b>    | Users refine questions responsibly                  | Users use follow-ups to drift outside scope                   |
| <b>Decision use</b>     | Users use answers for approved pilot workflows      | Users use pilot outputs for unapproved reporting or decisions |
| <b>Confidence</b>       | Users trust useful answers with appropriate caution | Users either over-trust or avoid the tool entirely            |

### 7.4. Error, refusal and clarification log

| Interaction ID | User role | Question type                       | Event                                                    | Expected behaviour? | Severity                       | Owner | Decision                                    |
|----------------|-----------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------|-------|---------------------------------------------|
|                |           | Supported / unsupported / ambiguous | Error / refusal / clarification / timeout / empty result | Yes / No / Unclear  | Low / Medium / High / Critical |       | Monitor / fix / educate / constrain / pause |

Example — illustrative:

| Interaction ID | User role        | Question type     | Event          | Expected behaviour? | Severity | Owner            | Decision                |
|----------------|------------------|-------------------|----------------|---------------------|----------|------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>T-1042</b>  | Regional manager | Margin by product | Refusal        | Yes                 | Low      | Product owner    | Log as future demand    |
| <b>T-1087</b>  | Sales analyst    | Revenue by region | Empty result   | No                  | Medium   | Data owner       | Investigate data filter |
| <b>T-1121</b>  | Sponsor          | Forecasting       | Partial answer | No                  | High     | Evaluation owner | Review refusal rule     |

## 7.5. Cost and latency review template

| Metric                              | Expected range | Observed value | Issue?   | Likely cause                                      | Action |
|-------------------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Median response time                |                |                | Yes / No | Model / query / retrieval / UI / network          |        |
| 95th percentile response time       |                |                | Yes / No |                                                   |        |
| Average model calls per interaction |                |                | Yes / No |                                                   |        |
| Average query execution cost        |                |                | Yes / No |                                                   |        |
| High-cost interactions              |                |                | Yes / No | Broad query / repeated follow-up / large result   |        |
| Timeout rate                        |                |                | Yes / No | Query complexity / infrastructure / model latency |        |
| Cost per active user                |                |                | Yes / No | Usage pattern / model choice / query cost         |        |

## 7.6. High-cost or high-latency interaction review

| Interaction | User role | Question | Cost / latency issue                                      | Likely driver                                                   | Decision                                       |
|-------------|-----------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
|             |           |          | High model cost / high query cost / timeout / slow answer | Broad date range / large result / repeated calls / complex join | Optimise / limit / educate / monitor / backlog |

Example — illustrative:

| Interaction   | User role     | Question                                                  | Cost / latency issue     | Likely driver                     | Decision                           |
|---------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>T-1204</b> | Sales manager | “Show all customers by product for the last three years.” | Slow and expensive query | Broad result and long time window | Add guidance and result-size limit |
| <b>T-1218</b> | Sales analyst | “Compare every region, segment and month.”                | High query cost          | Multi-dimensional broad query     | Review query guardrail             |

## 7.7. Support and escalation monitoring

| Signal                        | What to track                                      | Why it matters                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>Support volume</b>         | Tickets, questions, incident reports               | Tests supportability          |
| <b>Support type</b>           | Access, UI, answer, data, caveat, latency, refusal | Identifies root cause pattern |
| <b>Time to first response</b> | How quickly support engages                        | Shows operational readiness   |



|                           |                                             |                                                 |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Time to resolution</b> | How quickly issues are resolved             | Shows whether support route works               |
| <b>Escalation rate</b>    | Share of issues needing expert / build team | Tests whether support can operate independently |
| <b>Repeat issues</b>      | Same user, same question type, same error   | Indicates systemic gap                          |
| <b>Pause triggers</b>     | Issues requiring narrow / pause decision    | Tests governance route                          |

## 7.8. Monitoring review cadence

| Cadence                         | Focus                                                                              | Typical action                                   |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Daily during early pilot</b> | Blocking issues, access problems, misleading answers, exposure risk, major latency | Fix, constrain, pause or escalate                |
| <b>Weekly</b>                   | Usage patterns, trust, refusals, support load, cost, backlog                       | Update guidance, prioritise fixes, review scope  |
| <b>After hot fix</b>            | Did the fix work and avoid regression?                                             | Continue, retest, rollback or communicate        |
| <b>End of pilot</b>             | Value, safety, supportability, cost, Phase 8 implications                          | Decide proceed, constrain, extend, pause or stop |

## 7.9. Monitoring summary template

| Area                        | Summary                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Usage</b>                | Active users, sessions, question volume, follow-ups.                        |
| <b>Representative use</b>   | Whether usage came from normal users, experts, sponsors or champions.       |
| <b>Value pull</b>           | Evidence of sustained use, requests for more scope or workflow integration. |
| <b>Trust behaviour</b>      | Caveat use, verification, over-trust, low trust, escalation.                |
| <b>Boundary handling</b>    | Unsupported questions, refusals, clarifications, scope pressure.            |
| <b>Quality / errors</b>     | Errors, empty results, failed queries, misleading answers.                  |
| <b>Supportability</b>       | Support volume, repeated issues, escalation needs, build-team dependency.   |
| <b>Cost and latency</b>     | Cost drivers, slow interactions, heavy users, broad queries.                |
| <b>Risk events</b>          | Exposure concerns, misuse, material answer issues, pause triggers.          |
| <b>Decision implication</b> | Continue, fix, constrain, pause, extend or Phase 8 backlog.                 |

## 7.10. Common mistakes to avoid

| Mistake                                                       | Why it matters                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Measuring usage volume only</b>                            | High usage may hide misuse, cost pressure or unsupported demand.      |
| <b>Ignoring low usage</b>                                     | Low usage may reveal poor workflow fit, weak onboarding or low trust. |
| <b>Treating representative demand as production readiness</b> | Value pull matters, but safety and supportability still need Phase 8. |
| <b>Counting refusals without reviewing them</b>               | A refusal may be correct, confusing or blocking valid use.            |



|                                          |                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Monitoring cost too late</b>          | Cost patterns can become normalised before ownership is agreed. |
| <b>Not separating users by cohort</b>    | Champion-user usage may not represent wider adoption.           |
| <b>Dashboards without review cadence</b> | Monitoring only matters if it drives decisions.                 |
| <b>No link to triage</b>                 | Signals remain observations instead of controlled actions.      |

## 8. Activity 7: Review answer quality, caveat understanding and user interpretation

### 8.1. Real-interaction answer-quality review template

| Interaction ID | User role | Question type                       | Supported ?        | Answer quality                      | Caveat handling                  | User interpretation                  | Decision                                               |
|----------------|-----------|-------------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
|                |           | Supported / ambiguous / unsupported | Yes / No / Partial | Correct / partial / wrong / unclear | Clear / weak / missing / ignored | Understood / misunderstood / unknown | Accept / fix / educate / interview / constrain / pause |

Suggested review dimensions:

- Correct data source.
- Correct metric definition.
- Correct filters, grain and date logic.
- Correct access boundary.
- Appropriate caveats.
- Appropriate refusal or clarification.
- No unsupported causal claim, recommendation or confidence.
- User understood the answer in the intended way.

### 8.2. Answer-quality scoring guide

| Score                   | Meaning                                                                     | Typical action                                 |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pass</b>             | Answer is correct, grounded, caveated and understood.                       | Keep as positive evidence.                     |
| <b>Pass with caveat</b> | Answer is mostly correct but wording, caveat or interpretation risk exists. | Improve wording or guidance.                   |
| <b>Partial fail</b>     | Answer is technically usable but incomplete, unclear or weakly caveated.    | Fix, retest or monitor.                        |
| <b>Fail</b>             | Answer is wrong, misleading, unsafe or misunderstood in a material way.     | Triage, constrain or pause affected scope.     |
| <b>Unknown</b>          | Trace is insufficient or user interpretation is unclear.                    | Follow up through interview or support review. |

### 8.3. Caveat and limitation review

| Caveat area        | Review question                                              | Finding | Action |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------|--------|
| <b>Visibility</b>  | Was the caveat visible enough to the user?                   |         |        |
| <b>Wording</b>     | Was the caveat understandable to a non-expert user?          |         |        |
| <b>Timing</b>      | Was the caveat shown before the user relied on the answer?   |         |        |
| <b>Specificity</b> | Did it explain the actual limitation, not a generic warning? |         |        |
| <b>User action</b> | Did the user change behaviour because of the caveat?         |         |        |
| <b>Escalation</b>  | Did the caveat explain when to verify or escalate?           |         |        |

Example — illustrative:

| Caveat area        | Review question                | Finding                                               | Action                                           |
|--------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Visibility</b>  | Was the caveat visible enough? | Caveat appeared after the answer and was not noticed. | Move caveat closer to the key number.            |
| <b>Specificity</b> | Did it explain the limitation? | “Data may be incomplete” was too generic.             | State that current-month revenue is provisional. |
| <b>User action</b> | Did the user act on it?        | User used provisional value as final.                 | Improve wording and onboarding example.          |

### 8.4. Misunderstood-answer log

| Interaction ID | Answer was technically correct? | What user appeared to understand | Intended meaning | Risk                | Follow-up needed? | Decision                                                          |
|----------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------|---------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                | Yes / No / Partial              |                                  |                  | Low / Medium / High | Yes / No          | Wording fix / user education / interview / constraint / no action |

Example — illustrative:

| Interaction ID | Answer was technically correct? | What user appeared to understand                           | Intended meaning                             | Risk   | Follow-up needed? | Decision                                    |
|----------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|--------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>T-2041</b>  | Yes                             | User treated month-to-date revenue as final month revenue. | Current month is provisional and incomplete. | High   | Yes               | Change answer label and caveat placement.   |
| <b>T-2098</b>  | Yes                             | User read a variance as causal explanation.                | System only showed descriptive change.       | Medium | Yes               | Add wording: “This does not explain cause.” |

## 8.5. Follow-up interview trigger list

Some interactions cannot be judged from traces alone. Use this list to identify cases requiring a short interview.

| Trigger                                             | Why interview is needed                                                          | Example question to ask user                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| User gave negative feedback but trace looks correct | Need to understand expectation mismatch.                                         | What answer did you expect, and why?                          |
| User accepted a caveated answer                     | Need to know whether caveat changed behaviour.                                   | How did the caveat affect your decision?                      |
| User asked many follow-ups                          | Need to know whether exploration was useful or compensating for unclear answers. | Were the follow-ups helping, or was the first answer unclear? |
| User abandoned session                              | Need to understand whether issue was trust, UX, latency or workflow fit.         | What made you stop using the answer?                          |
| User used answer in workflow                        | Need to confirm decision context and risk.                                       | How did you use the answer afterwards?                        |
| User repeatedly asked unsupported questions         | Need to separate guidance gap from unmet demand.                                 | Did you know this was outside scope?                          |
| User did not give feedback despite heavy use        | Need to surface silent issues or overconfidence.                                 | Did anything feel unclear, risky or particularly useful?      |

## 8.6. User interpretation interview guide

| Area           | Questions                                                         |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Context        | What were you trying to achieve when you asked the question?      |
| Expectation    | What answer did you expect before using the system?               |
| Interpretation | What did you understand from the answer?                          |
| Caveats        | Did you notice the caveat or limitation? What did it mean to you? |
| Trust          | Did you trust the answer? Why or why not?                         |
| Verification   | Did you check the answer elsewhere or ask someone?                |
| Action         | Did the answer change what you did next?                          |
| Confusion      | Was anything unclear, missing or misleading?                      |
| Boundary       | Did you understand whether the question was in scope?             |
| Improvement    | What would make the answer safer or more useful?                  |

## 8.7. Refusal and clarification understanding review

| Interaction ID | Behaviour                          | Expected?          | User understood why? | Issue                                                                          | Action                            |
|----------------|------------------------------------|--------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
|                | Refusal / clarification / redirect | Yes / No / Partial | Yes / No / Unknown   | Boundary unclear / wording unclear / refusal wrong / user expectation mismatch | Educate / rewrite / fix / backlog |

Example — illustrative:

| Interaction ID | Behaviour     | Expected? | User understood why? | Issue                                             | Action                                         |
|----------------|---------------|-----------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| T-2120         | Refusal       | Yes       | No                   | User thought system was broken, not out of scope. | Improve refusal wording and quick-start guide. |
| T-2152         | Clarification | Yes       | Yes                  | User selected region and continued.               | Positive evidence.                             |

## 8.8. Answer-format improvement log

| Issue                                   | Example | Risk                                    | Proposed improvement                                | Owner | Retest needed? |
|-----------------------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------|
| <b>Caveat too low in answer</b>         |         | User misses limitation.                 | Move caveat near key number.                        |       | Yes / No       |
| <b>Metric label unclear</b>             |         | User misunderstands definition.         | Add metric label and definition link.               |       | Yes / No       |
| <b>Descriptive answer sounds causal</b> |         | User infers unsupported cause.          | Add “descriptive only” wording.                     |       | Yes / No       |
| <b>Refusal too generic</b>              |         | User does not know what to ask instead. | Add boundary and alternative suggestion.            |       | Yes / No       |
| <b>Confidence wording misleading</b>    |         | User over-trusts answer.                | Use plain-language confidence / evidence statement. |       | Yes / No       |

## 8.9. Real-interaction review summary

| Area                                 | Summary                                                         |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Interactions reviewed</b>         | Number and selection method.                                    |
| <b>Supported questions</b>           | Pass / partial / fail patterns.                                 |
| <b>Unsupported questions</b>         | Refusal, redirect and boundary handling.                        |
| <b>Ambiguous questions</b>           | Clarification quality and completion.                           |
| <b>Caveat understanding</b>          | Main caveats understood or misunderstood.                       |
| <b>Misunderstood correct answers</b> | Count, examples and risk level.                                 |
| <b>Follow-up interviews needed</b>   | Users / interactions selected and reason.                       |
| <b>Main fixes</b>                    | Wording, UI, caveat, guidance, data, semantic or model changes. |
| <b>Pilot decision implication</b>    | Continue / fix / constrain / pause / Phase 8 backlog.           |

## 8.10. Common mistakes to avoid

| Mistake                                                           | Why it matters                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Reviewing answer correctness only</b>                          | A correct answer may still be misunderstood or misused.                                  |
| <b>Assuming caveats are understood because they are displayed</b> | Users may not notice, read or act on them.                                               |
| <b>Treating refusals as failures by default</b>                   | A refusal may be the correct safe behaviour.                                             |
| <b>Ignoring technically correct but misleading wording</b>        | The answer can create unsupported causal or decision claims.                             |
| <b>Diagnosing user intent from logs alone</b>                     | Some interactions require short interviews.                                              |
| <b>Reviewing only bad answers</b>                                 | Positive interactions show what wording and patterns should be reused.                   |
| <b>Not linking interpretation issues to traces</b>                | The team cannot determine whether the problem is user, product, data or model behaviour. |

## 9. Activity 8: Triage issues and decide whether to continue, constrain, remediate, pause or redesign

### 9.1. Pilot issue triage log

| Issue ID | Source                                                                | Description | User / cohort | Question type                       | Evidence link                 | Issue category                                                                          | Severity                       | Decision                                                                 | Owner |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
|          | Feedback / trace / monitoring / support / access test / answer review |             |               | Supported / unsupported / ambiguous | Trace / ticket / session note | Product / data / semantic / access / model / user education / support / process / scope | Low / Medium / High / Critical | Continue / monitor / educate / fix / constrain / pause / redesign / stop |       |

Suggested issue categories:

- Product / UI issue.
- Data quality, freshness or availability issue.
- Semantic issue: metric, definition, grain, join, filter or caveat.
- Access or permission issue.
- Model / orchestration issue.
- Unsupported-scope demand.
- User education or documentation issue.
- Support or operating process issue.
- Cost, latency or performance issue.
- Governance, risk or escalation issue.

### 9.2. Severity and urgency guide

Severity should reflect both technical impact and business context.

| Level         | Typical meaning                                                     | Example response                          |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Low</b>    | Minor issue with limited impact and no material risk.               | Monitor, document or fix later.           |
| <b>Medium</b> | Repeated issue, user confusion or friction affecting pilot quality. | Fix, educate, update guidance or backlog. |

|                 |                                                                                                             |                                                |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>High</b>     | Issue affects supported answers, trust, access, supportability or decision use.                             | Triage urgently; consider constraint or pause. |
| <b>Critical</b> | Data exposure, materially misleading answer, unsafe reliance, broken auditability or major control failure. | Pause affected scope immediately and escalate. |

Urgency modifiers:

| Modifier                              | Why it changes priority                                              |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Senior decision maker affected</b> | Small issues may damage trust or block sponsorship.                  |
| <b>Critical workflow timing</b>       | Issue appears during board, trading, reporting or operational cycle. |
| <b>Repeated occurrence</b>            | Pattern suggests systemic failure, not isolated bug.                 |
| <b>High-confidence user impact</b>    | User relied on, or was likely to rely on, the output.                |
| <b>Exposure or access risk</b>        | Even one case may justify immediate pause.                           |
| <b>Public / visible pilot moment</b>  | Trust impact may exceed technical severity.                          |
| <b>Easy safe fix available</b>        | Quick fix may be justified if tested and controlled.                 |

### 9.3. Decision route matrix

| Decision                    | Use when                                                                              | Evidence required                                    | Typical owner                 |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>Continue</b>             | Issue is low risk and understood.                                                     | Issue note and monitoring signal.                    | Product owner.                |
| <b>Monitor</b>              | Pattern is unclear or not yet material.                                               | Trace / feedback and review point.                   | Product / evaluation owner.   |
| <b>Educate</b>              | Issue is mainly user guidance or misunderstanding.                                    | User feedback, examples, guidance gap.               | Product owner / business SME. |
| <b>Fix during pilot</b>     | Issue is bounded, low-risk and testable.                                              | Fix note, test evidence, communication plan.         | Product / technical owner.    |
| <b>Constrain</b>            | Risk is localised to users, questions, data or answer types.                          | Affected scope and constraint rationale.             | Product owner + risk owner.   |
| <b>Pause affected scope</b> | Continued use may be unsafe or misleading.                                            | Severity evidence, pause trigger, restart condition. | Pause authority.              |
| <b>Redesign</b>             | Issue reveals structural workflow, data, semantic, orchestration or support weakness. | Root-cause evidence and impact assessment.           | Decision forum.               |
| <b>Stop</b>                 | Value, risk or operating model is not credible enough to continue.                    | Pilot evidence pack and sponsor decision.            | Sponsor / decision forum.     |

### 9.4. Root-cause classification guide

| Symptom                                | Possible root causes to test                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>User says answer is wrong</b>       | Data source, metric definition, filter, access boundary, query generation, user expectation. |
| <b>User asks unsupported questions</b> | Guidance gap, natural demand beyond scope, wrong cohort, future backlog opportunity.         |



|                                        |                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Caveats ignored</b>                 | Poor caveat placement, unclear wording, over-trust, weak onboarding, high-pressure workflow.   |
| <b>Refusal frustrates user</b>         | Wrong refusal, unclear boundary, genuine unmet need, poor redirect, unsupported scope.         |
| <b>Slow interaction</b>                | Model latency, query cost, retrieval, validation, result size, infrastructure or network.      |
| <b>Support cannot diagnose issue</b>   | Missing traces, unclear ownership, weak runbook, no support access, unclear issue taxonomy.    |
| <b>Access issue</b>                    | IAM sync, role mapping, row-level security, stale permissions, app cache, manual provisioning. |
| <b>Positive feedback but risky use</b> | Over-trust, wrong decision context, sponsor bias, unclear pilot limitation.                    |

## 9.5. Continue / constrain / pause decision record

| Field                          | Decision                                                         |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Issue ID</b>                |                                                                  |
| <b>Decision</b>                | Continue / constrain / pause / restart / redesign / stop         |
| <b>Affected users</b>          |                                                                  |
| <b>Affected question types</b> |                                                                  |
| <b>Affected data / assets</b>  |                                                                  |
| <b>Evidence reviewed</b>       | Trace, feedback, ticket, monitoring, answer review, access test. |
| <b>Rationale</b>               |                                                                  |
| <b>Immediate action</b>        |                                                                  |
| <b>Communication required</b>  | Users / support / sponsor / governance / security.               |
| <b>Restart condition</b>       |                                                                  |
| <b>Owner</b>                   |                                                                  |
| <b>Review date</b>             |                                                                  |

Example — illustrative:

| Field                          | Decision                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Issue ID</b>                | P7-034                                                                                            |
| <b>Decision</b>                | Constrain                                                                                         |
| <b>Affected users</b>          | Regional sales managers                                                                           |
| <b>Affected question types</b> | Month-to-date revenue comparison                                                                  |
| <b>Evidence reviewed</b>       | Three traces, two feedback comments, caveat review.                                               |
| <b>Rationale</b>               | Answers were technically correct but users interpreted provisional current-month values as final. |
| <b>Immediate action</b>        | Add stronger caveat and restrict use in reporting-cycle pack.                                     |
| <b>Communication required</b>  | Notify pilot users and support channel.                                                           |
| <b>Restart condition</b>       | Retest answer wording and confirm caveat understanding with two users.                            |
| <b>Owner</b>                   | Product owner                                                                                     |
| <b>Review date</b>             |                                                                                                   |

## 9.6. Hot-fix versus backlog classification

| Item type                     | Definition                                                                | Typical route                        |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Hot fix</b>                | Urgent bounded fix needed to keep pilot safe or usable.                   | Fix, test, communicate, record.      |
| <b>Quick win</b>              | Low-risk improvement that improves usability, guidance or supportability. | Fix if inside approved boundary.     |
| <b>Pilot constraint</b>       | Temporary reduction of users, questions, data or answer types.            | Approve and communicate.             |
| <b>Phase 8 item</b>           | Required before production readiness or broader release.                  | Add to production-readiness backlog. |
| <b>Later enhancement</b>      | Useful but not required for pilot or production readiness.                | Add to future roadmap.               |
| <b>Stop / redesign signal</b> | Issue challenges value, architecture, workflow fit or operating model.    | Escalate to decision forum.          |

## 9.7. Triage meeting agenda

1. Review new high-severity issues and pause triggers.
2. Review issues linked to supported questions first.
3. Review access, exposure, auditability and misleading-answer risks.
4. Review repeated user confusion, unsupported demand and support burden.
5. Classify root cause and severity.
6. Decide continue, monitor, educate, fix, constrain, pause, redesign or stop.
7. Assign owner, evidence required and review date.
8. Confirm user, support or sponsor communication.
9. Update pilot backlog and Phase 8 implications.

## 9.8. Example triage cases — illustrative

| Case                                                                      | Classification                    | Decision                                 | Rationale                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Senior sponsor sees incorrect regional filter in supported answer.</b> | Access / query / trust issue      | Pause affected question type             | Small number of users affected, but high trust and exposure impact.          |
| <b>Users repeatedly ask for margin, which is out of scope.</b>            | Unsupported demand / semantic gap | Continue, log demand, reinforce guidance | Not a defect if refusal is correct; useful future scope signal.              |
| <b>Caveat displayed but users miss it.</b>                                | Product / user interpretation     | Quick fix                                | Move caveat closer to key number and retest.                                 |
| <b>High latency for broad queries.</b>                                    | Cost / performance                | Constrain and educate                    | Add result-size guidance and monitor expensive patterns.                     |
| <b>Support cannot access trace evidence.</b>                              | Support / observability           | Fix before expansion                     | Pilot can continue for small cohort, but Phase 8 needs support trace access. |
| <b>Low usage from target users.</b>                                       | Adoption / workflow fit           | Extend and interview users               | Insufficient evidence; may be timing,                                        |

|  |  |  |                            |
|--|--|--|----------------------------|
|  |  |  | onboarding or value issue. |
|--|--|--|----------------------------|

## 9.9. Phase 8 carry-forward log

| Issue | Why not fully resolved in Phase 7                                    | Production-readiness implication | Owner | Priority            |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------|---------------------|
|       | Accepted for pilot / workaround / outside pilot scope / needs design |                                  |       | High / Medium / Low |

Example — illustrative:

| Issue                                                | Why not fully resolved in Phase 7     | Production-readiness implication                               | Owner           | Priority |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------|
| <b>Role-change propagation timing not automated.</b> | Manual workaround accepted for pilot. | Phase 8 must define access-change SLA and automation route.    | Operating owner | High     |
| <b>Support trace view is limited.</b>                | Build team can support small pilot.   | Broader release requires redacted trace dashboard for support. | Technical owner | High     |
| <b>Margin demand frequent but unsupported.</b>       | Metric not approved.                  | Future scope requires semantic definition and validation.      | Semantic owner  | Medium   |

## 9.10. Common mistakes to avoid

| Mistake                                        | Why it matters                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Treating all feedback equally</b>           | A minor issue in a critical workflow may be more urgent than a larger issue in an unused path. |
| <b>Fixing before classifying</b>               | The team may patch symptoms while leaving data, semantic or access causes unresolved.          |
| <b>Ignoring user role and decision context</b> | Severity depends on who saw the issue and what they were trying to do.                         |
| <b>Using backlog as a dumping ground</b>       | Some issues require immediate constraint, pause or escalation.                                 |
| <b>Treating unsupported demand as defect</b>   | Scope pressure should be separated from approved-scope performance.                            |
| <b>Continuing despite broken boundary</b>      | The pilot stops being controlled if unsafe exposure continues.                                 |
| <b>Not recording judgement calls</b>           | Triage is partly judgement-based; decisions need rationale, owner and review point.            |

## 10. Activity 9: Manage pilot backlog, hot fixes and controlled change

### 10.1. Controlled pilot backlog template

| Backlog ID | Source                                           | Description | Category                                                                                    | Priority            | Decision route                                      | Owner | Target phase            | Status |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------|--------|
|            | Feedback / trace / monitoring / support / triage |             | Hot fix / quick win / pilot constraint / Phase 8 item / later enhancement / redesign signal | High / Medium / Low | Fix / constrain / pause / backlog / redesign / stop |       | Pilot / Phase 8 / later |        |

Suggested categories:

- Hot fix.
- Quick win.
- Pilot constraint.
- Phase 8 production-readiness item.
- Later enhancement.
- Redesign signal.
- Stop / pause signal.

### 10.2. Hot-fix decision checklist

| Question                                                                                                | Yes / No | Notes |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|
| Is the issue inside the approved pilot boundary?                                                        |          |       |
| Is the fix bounded and well understood?                                                                 |          |       |
| Is the risk of the change lower than the risk of leaving the issue unresolved?                          |          |       |
| Can the fix be tested before release?                                                                   |          |       |
| Are relevant regression tests available?                                                                |          |       |
| Does the fix affect answer behaviour, caveats, refusal logic, access, model routing or supported scope? |          |       |
| Does the fix require user or support communication?                                                     |          |       |
| Is there a rollback or reversal route if the fix creates regression?                                    |          |       |
| Has the owner approved release into the pilot?                                                          |          |       |

Recommended decision values: Release / Release with caveat / Defer / Constrain / Pause / Escalate.

### 10.3. Change classification guide

| Change type                   | Examples                                                             | Typical control                                  |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| User guidance update          | Clarify supported questions, caveats, feedback route, cost guidance. | Product review and user communication.           |
| Support guidance update       | Add triage route, known issue, escalation step.                      | Support owner review.                            |
| UI wording fix                | Improve labels, caveat placement, refusal text.                      | Product review and light regression test.        |
| Answer-format fix             | Change answer structure, source display, caveat layout.              | Answer-quality regression test.                  |
| Prompt / model-routing change | Adjust prompt, routing, model task allocation.                       | Evaluation / regression test before release.     |
| Validation-rule change        | Change query validation, refusal, guardrail or limit.                | Technical and risk review; retest failure cases. |
| Metadata / semantic change    | Change metric description, synonym, caveat, join guidance.           | Semantic owner approval and regression test.     |
| Access handling change        | Role mapping, permission logic, row-level rule, user group update.   | Security / access review and access tests.       |
| Scope change                  | New users, data, questions, answer types or domains.                 | Formal pilot boundary approval.                  |

### 10.4. Hot-fix release record

| Field                         | Description                                                                             |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fix ID                        |                                                                                         |
| Issue addressed               |                                                                                         |
| Fix type                      | Guidance / UI / prompt / validation / metadata / access / monitoring / support / other. |
| Reason for hot fix            | Why this cannot wait for Phase 8 or later backlog.                                      |
| Affected users / scope        |                                                                                         |
| Expected behaviour before fix |                                                                                         |
| Expected behaviour after fix  |                                                                                         |
| Tests completed               |                                                                                         |
| Regression checks completed   |                                                                                         |
| Communication required        | Users / support / operators / sponsor / governance.                                     |
| Release owner                 |                                                                                         |
| Approval                      |                                                                                         |
| Release date                  |                                                                                         |
| Rollback / reversal route     |                                                                                         |
| Post-release review date      |                                                                                         |

Example — illustrative:

| Field                        | Description                                                                               |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fix ID                       | HF-007                                                                                    |
| Issue addressed              | Users misunderstood current-month revenue caveat.                                         |
| Fix type                     | Answer format / caveat wording.                                                           |
| Reason for hot fix           | Supported answer was technically correct but creating interpretation risk.                |
| Affected users / scope       | Sales performance pilot users.                                                            |
| Expected behaviour after fix | Caveat appears next to current-month number and states “provisional month-to-date value”. |
| Tests completed              | Golden question rerun, caveat review, answer-format check.                                |
| Communication required       | Pilot users and support channel.                                                          |
| Release owner                | Product owner.                                                                            |
| Post-release review date     | Next pilot review meeting.                                                                |

## 10.5. Regression check template

| Regression area       | Check                                                             | Required for                                    |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Supported questions   | Previously supported questions still answer correctly.            | Prompt, model, metadata, answer-format changes. |
| Unsupported questions | Refusals and redirects still work.                                | Prompt, validation, refusal wording changes.    |
| Access boundary       | User permissions and data restrictions still apply.               | Access, metadata, query or execution changes.   |
| Caveat handling       | Required caveats still appear and are understandable.             | Answer-format, prompt or metadata changes.      |
| Query safety          | Queries remain bounded, valid and within approved assets.         | Prompt, SQL generation, validation changes.     |
| Cost / latency        | Change does not materially increase response time or cost.        | Model, retrieval, query or validation changes.  |
| Traceability          | Logs still capture question, context, query, answer and feedback. | UI, orchestration, logging or release changes.  |
| User experience       | Change does not confuse users or contradict guidance.             | UI, wording, caveat or answer-format changes.   |

## 10.6. User and support change note template

Use this when a change affects user-visible behaviour.

| Section                          | Content                                                 |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| What changed                     | Plain-language description of the change.               |
| Why it changed                   | Issue, feedback or risk addressed.                      |
| Who is affected                  | Users, roles, workflows or question types affected.     |
| What users should do differently | Any change in behaviour, interpretation or escalation.  |
| Known caveats                    | Remaining limitation after the fix.                     |
| Support note                     | What support should know if users ask about the change. |
| Effective date                   | When the change is live.                                |
| Contact / escalation             | Where to report issues.                                 |

Example — illustrative:

We have updated how current-month revenue answers are displayed. Current-month values are now labelled as provisional month-to-date figures and the caveat appears next to the number. This change was made because some users interpreted current-month values as final monthly results. Please continue to verify provisional figures before using them in reporting-cycle decisions.

## 10.7. Pilot change log

| Change ID | Date | Change summary | Change type                                        | Owner | Tests completed | Users informed? | Status                                    |
|-----------|------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------|-----------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------|
|           |      |                | Hot fix / quick win / constraint / material change |       |                 | Yes / No / N/A  | Draft / Released / Rolled back / Deferred |

## 10.8. Phase 8 backlog separation

| Item | Why not fixed during pilot                                                          | Phase 8 implication | Required owner | Priority            |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------|---------------------|
|      | Too large / needs security review / needs design / outside pilot scope / not urgent |                     |                | High / Medium / Low |

Example — illustrative:

| Item                              | Why not fixed during pilot            | Phase 8 implication                                           | Required owner                 | Priority |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------|
| Automated role-change propagation | Manual workaround accepted for pilot. | Required before broader release.                              | Operating owner / access owner | High     |
| Support trace dashboard           | Build team can support small pilot.   | Needed before wider support model.                            | Technical owner                | High     |
| Margin question support           | Metric not approved.                  | Requires semantic definition and validation before inclusion. | Semantic owner                 | Medium   |

## 10.9. Post-fix review template

| Fix ID | Review question                                             | Result |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
|        | Did the fix resolve the original issue?                     |        |
|        | Did the fix introduce regression?                           |        |
|        | Did users and support understand the change?                |        |
|        | Did the fix affect cost, latency, access or answer quality? |        |
|        | Does the issue remain open, move to Phase 8 or close?       |        |

## 10.10. Common mistakes to avoid

| Mistake                                                       | Why it matters                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Releasing hot fixes without telling users                     | Users may misinterpret changed behaviour or compare old and new answers incorrectly. |
| Treating a hot fix as a small change without regression tests | Small wording, prompt or validation changes can alter answer behaviour materially.   |
| Expanding scope through fixes                                 | The pilot boundary changes without approval.                                         |
| Fixing symptoms repeatedly                                    | The team may miss a structural data, semantic, access or workflow issue.             |
| Not separating pilot fixes from Phase 8 items                 | Production-readiness work becomes hidden inside pilot backlog.                       |
| No version history                                            | The team cannot explain which behaviour users saw at which point in the pilot.       |
| No rollback route                                             | A failed fix can make the pilot less safe than before.                               |



## 11. Activity 10: Assess adoption, workflow fit, supportability and Phase 8 implications

### 11.1. Pilot decision summary template

| Area                             | Summary                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pilot objective</b>           |                                                                                            |
| <b>Pilot users / cohort</b>      |                                                                                            |
| <b>Pilot duration</b>            |                                                                                            |
| <b>Evidence coverage</b>         | Usage, feedback, traces, monitored sessions, support tickets, interviews.                  |
| <b>Main value signals</b>        |                                                                                            |
| <b>Main risk signals</b>         |                                                                                            |
| <b>Supportability findings</b>   |                                                                                            |
| <b>Production-readiness gaps</b> |                                                                                            |
| <b>Recommended decision</b>      | Proceed to Phase 8 / proceed with constraints / extend / narrow / pause / redesign / stop. |
| <b>Decision rationale</b>        |                                                                                            |
| <b>Decision owner</b>            |                                                                                            |
| <b>Review date</b>               |                                                                                            |

### 11.2. Adoption evidence review

| Signal                           | Evidence | Interpretation                                         | Caveat |
|----------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| <b>Sustained use</b>             |          | Strong workflow value / curiosity / dependency / other |        |
| <b>Repeat users</b>              |          | Users are returning after initial trial                |        |
| <b>Low usage</b>                 |          | Poor fit / weak onboarding / low trust / wrong timing  |        |
| <b>Requests for more scope</b>   |          | Value pull / scope pressure / unmet need               |        |
| <b>Requests for integration</b>  |          | Workflow relevance and potential operating value       |        |
| <b>Champion-heavy usage</b>      |          | Useful early signal but not representative             |        |
| <b>Representative-user usage</b> |          | Stronger adoption evidence                             |        |
| <b>Drop-off after first use</b>  |          | Curiosity spike or disappointment                      |        |

Example — illustrative:

| Signal                                    | Evidence                                                           | Interpretation                    | Caveat                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sustained use by regional managers</b> | 8 of 12 target users used the tool weekly for trading review prep. | Strong workflow-fit signal.       | Pilot users were motivated and supported closely.                                 |
| <b>Requests for margin questions</b>      | 15 unsupported requests across 6 users.                            | Clear demand for scope expansion. | Margin metric not approved; not evidence that production scope should expand now. |

### 11.3. Workflow-fit assessment

| Workflow | User group | Current pain point                                                                        | Pilot evidence | Fit assessment                    | Decision implication              |
|----------|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
|          |            | Slow answer / analyst dependency / dashboard gap / inconsistent metric / exploration need |                | Strong / partial / weak / unclear | Proceed / improve / narrow / stop |

Suggested fit indicators:

- Users ask real workflow questions, not only test prompts.
- The MVP supports follow-up exploration better than existing dashboards.
- Users can use answers without build-team coaching.
- The answer is timely enough for the decision cycle.
- The tool reduces friction without creating unacceptable support or trust risk.
- Users ask for workflow integration, not just broader novelty access.

### 11.4. Value evidence template

| Value area              | Evidence to capture                                                | Example                                         |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Speed</b>            | Time saved versus current process.                                 | Faster trading review preparation.              |
| <b>Exploration</b>      | Follow-up questions answered without analyst queue.                | User drills from region to segment.             |
| <b>Consistency</b>      | Users receive answers using approved definitions.                  | Revenue definition applied consistently.        |
| <b>Trust</b>            | Users understand source, caveat and limitation.                    | User verifies surprising result before using.   |
| <b>Analyst leverage</b> | Reduced dependency on repetitive analyst requests.                 | Analyst focuses on exceptions, not simple cuts. |
| <b>Decision support</b> | Better preparation, faster review or clearer issue identification. | Manager identifies declining segment earlier.   |

### 11.5. Supportability assessment

| Area                         | Evidence                                                      | Assessment                        | Phase 8 implication |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Support volume</b>        | Tickets, questions, incidents                                 | Low / manageable / high / unclear |                     |
| <b>Support type</b>          | Access, UI, answer, caveat, latency, data, unsupported demand |                                   |                     |
| <b>Escalation need</b>       | Share requiring data, AI, security or build team              |                                   |                     |
| <b>Build-team dependency</b> | How often build team had to explain, fix or diagnose          |                                   |                     |
| <b>Access lifecycle</b>      | Onboarding, role change, offboarding, revocation              |                                   |                     |
| <b>Monitoring usability</b>  | Could support / operators use dashboards and traces?          |                                   |                     |

Phase 7 Annexes:

Controlled pilot and user testing

|                              |                                                      |  |  |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| <b>Documentation quality</b> | Could users and support self-serve common questions? |  |  |
| <b>Incident handling</b>     | Were incidents triaged, owned and resolved?          |  |  |

## 11.6. Phase 8 production-readiness backlog

| Backlog item | Source evidence                                            | Why it matters for production | Owner | Priority            | Required before go-live? |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------|---------------------|--------------------------|
|              | Trace / feedback / support / monitoring / interview / test |                               |       | High / Medium / Low | Yes / No / Conditional   |

Suggested backlog categories:

- Access lifecycle and administration.
- Monitoring and alert thresholds.
- Support model and runbook.
- Documentation and onboarding.
- Cost ownership and budget controls.
- Evaluation and regression tests.
- Security / privacy / audit evidence.
- Reliability, latency and resilience.
- Data / semantic remediation.
- UX, answer format and caveat clarity.
- Scope expansion candidates.
- Governance and release decisioning.

## 11.7. Decision recommendation guide

| Recommendation                  | Use when                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Proceed to Phase 8</b>       | Value, controlled use, supportability and risk evidence are strong enough.                    |
| <b>Proceed with constraints</b> | Phase 8 can start, but with reduced scope, users, data, answer types or assumptions.          |
| <b>Extend pilot</b>             | Evidence is promising but incomplete, unrepresentative or affected by timing.                 |
| <b>Narrow pilot</b>             | Value exists, but risk or support burden is concentrated in part of the scope.                |
| <b>Pause and remediate</b>      | Continued use may mislead users, expose data, overload support or damage trust.               |
| <b>Redesign</b>                 | Workflow, data, semantic, orchestration, access or support assumptions are structurally weak. |
| <b>Stop</b>                     | The value case, risk profile or operating model is not credible enough to continue.           |

## 11.8. Decision wording examples — illustrative

### Proceed to Phase 8

The pilot provides sufficient evidence to proceed to production-readiness assessment for the approved sales performance scope. Representative users used the MVP in weekly workflow preparation, feedback was trace-linked, support load was manageable, and material risks are captured in the Phase 8 backlog. Production readiness should focus on access lifecycle, monitoring thresholds, support model, documentation and run-cost ownership.

### Proceed with constraints

The pilot should proceed to Phase 8 with constraints. Revenue and pipeline questions showed clear workflow value, but current-month caveats and unsupported margin demand create interpretation and scope risk. Phase 8 should exclude margin, strengthen caveat presentation, define production support ownership and validate access lifecycle before release.

### Extend pilot

The pilot should be extended because evidence is promising but insufficient. Usage was concentrated among sponsors and expert users, with limited evidence from representative business users. The extension should focus on normal-user onboarding, real workflow use, support burden and trust calibration.

### Pause and remediate

The affected pilot scope should pause while remediation is completed. Supported answers were technically correct but repeatedly misunderstood in a reporting-cycle context. Usage should restart only after answer wording, caveat placement, user guidance and regression evidence are reviewed.

### Stop

The pilot should stop for this use case. Usage remained low after onboarding and follow-up, users did not connect the MVP to a recurring workflow, and the support and semantic effort required is not justified by the observed value. A dashboard or analyst workflow improvement should be reconsidered.

## 11.9. Pilot caveat statement template

Use this where the evidence is useful but not fully representative.

Pilot findings should be interpreted with caution because [user cohort / timing / workflow coverage / data scope / support model] was limited. The pilot provides useful evidence on [value / feasibility / user behaviour / supportability], but under-tests [normal users / low-adoption users / broader access lifecycle / high-volume usage / production support / regulated workflow]. These caveats should be reflected in the Phase 8 scope and decision.

Example — illustrative:

Pilot findings should be interpreted with caution because usage was concentrated among motivated sales operations users and the commercial sponsor. The pilot provides useful evidence on workflow value and high-intent usage, but under-tests normal sales-manager onboarding, low-trust users and broader support load. These caveats should be reflected in the Phase 8 scope and decision.

## 11.10. Common mistakes to avoid

| Mistake                                                  | Why it matters                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Treating positive feedback as production evidence</b> | Users may like the tool before it is safe, supportable or cost-controlled.                  |
| <b>Ignoring representative-user evidence</b>             | Sustained use by real target users is one of the strongest value signals.                   |
| <b>Presenting champion usage as broad adoption</b>       | Sponsor enthusiasm may overstate normal-user readiness.                                     |
| <b>Mixing blockers and enhancements</b>                  | Phase 8 needs to know what blocks production, not just what users want.                     |
| <b>Ignoring support dependency</b>                       | A pilot that relies on the build team may not scale operationally.                          |
| <b>Expanding scope because users ask for more</b>        | Demand is useful evidence, but new scope still needs semantic, access and validation work.  |
| <b>Forgetting evidence caveats</b>                       | Phase 8 may overestimate readiness if pilot cohort, timing or workflow coverage was narrow. |
| <b>Ending with a feature backlog only</b>                | The pilot should produce a production-readiness decision, not just product requests.        |